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A desert adventure to remember

Hundreds of participants took part in the 43rd Gulf News Overnighter Fun Drive — the Tilal Swaihan Experience, as avid off-roaders navigated the Al Ain dunes. From thrilling off-road trails to entertainment, food, and music, this iconic event was filled with unforgettable moments.

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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

More Indians to avail UAE visa on arrival

Indians from six more countries to benefit from facility

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

The UAE's expanded visa-on-arrival programme for Indian nationals with effect from February 13 has extended the facility to Indi-

an nationals residing in more countries.

Nine nations so far

Indian citizens holding ordinary passports and valid visas, residence permits, or Green Cards from Singapore, Japan, South Korea, Australia, New Zealand and Canada, will be granted visas upon arrival at all UAE entry points. These are in addition to the previously eligible nations, name-

ly the US, European Union, UK. Individuals from eligible countries will receive the visa on arrival in the UAE, provided their passport is valid for at least six months and they pay the applicable visa fees as per UAE regulations.

The entry visa fee for a 14-day stay is Dh100, with an option to extend for an additional 14 days at a cost of Dh250. Additionally, a 60-day visa is available for Dh250.

Dubai tenants must get 90-day rent hike notice

LANDLORDS TO CLEARLY NOTIFY OF INCREASE WELL BEFORE LEASE EXPIRY

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

Tenants in Dubai will have to be notified 'at least' 90 days in advance by the landlord about any rent increase they are planning for a renewed contract. If this is not followed, there can be no increases.

Market sources say there had been instances of 'arbitrary rental hike demands' by some landlords during renewal time — and without giving their tenants lead time on what sort of increases they must expect.

According to brokers, the move by the Dubai Land Department (DLD) definitely rates as a 'tenant-friendly' move. Tenants get clarity of what they are being asked to pay, and they get that a good three months prior to renewal time.

Clear framework

"A clear framework has been established to manage rent increases, considering the timing of the landlord's notification to the tenant and the contract renewal date," the DLD statement said.

The DLD had introduced a

new digital rental index at the start of 2025 to provide real-time data of trends in the rental market and at the same time, bring down disputes between landlords and tenants over sudden and sharp rental hikes.

According to the DLD, in cases where the landlord provided the required 90-day notice and the 'previous index supported the increase, but the new index does not', then the renewal date will determine which index applies:

■ The previous index will be applied if the contract was renewed before 2025.

■ The new index will be enforced if the contract is renewed during 2025.

Until 2025, the DLD was operating a rental index system that was updated on a yearly basis. The number of areas that were covered too were limited to in-demand freehold and non-freehold districts.

With the new digital rental index, more areas in the city have come under the coverage of the platform.

"The Smart Rental Index helps curb inflation and enables stakeholders to make informed investment decisions based on reliable data," said Majid Al Marri, CEO of the Real Estate Registration Sector at DLD.

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